



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Let's read a news article!



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe events in the news in a range of social and work contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about nature and the animal world.
- I can talk about local and international news.
- I can talk about hypothetical situations.

Ask your partner:

- When was the last time you read or heard about animals in the news? What was it about?
- Do you think animals know when people are in trouble? Why or why not?





Let's Explore!

Let's read a news article - who is Angel?



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Vero Beach, Florida June 28
"Angel" Saves Child at Beach

A child feared drowned was discovered safe and sound late this afternoon in the care of a large dolphin.

Caleb MacDonald, age 5, came to Vero Beach with his parents on Friday for a one-week vacation. As his parents rested on the beach, Caleb slipped quietly into the water for a swim.

He just started taking swimming lessons, and wanted to surprise his parents with his swimming ability. When his parents awoke, they discovered that Caleb was missing and feared the worst.

"He's such an adventurous boy," said his mother tearfully. "We're grateful he's safe, though we're still upset. There are no lifeguards at this beach."

Caleb was swept out into the ocean and was unable to swim back. Miraculously, a dolphin that locals are now calling "Angel" spotted the boy and carried him to safety. The boy and the dolphin were seen by another swimmer who started to shout. "You hear a lot about how intelligent dolphins are," said one Vero Beach local. "But I've never heard of anything like this happening before. It's a real miracle." Caleb said: "If Angel could understand English, I would tell him that I love him."





Let's Practice!

Extra! Extra!* Read all about it!

*"Extra! Extra!" was a phrase used by newspaper salesmen to get the attention of the public.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Choose the correct answer.

- 1) A child _____ safe and sound late this afternoon in the care of a large dolphin.
 - a. is discovered
 - b. discovered
 - c. was discovered
- 2) Caleb _____ out into the ocean.
 - a. was swept
 - b. is swept
 - c. swept
- 3) The boy and the dolphin _____ by another swimmer.
 - a. were saw
 - b. was see
 - c. were seen
- 4) Caleb _____ to safety by the dolphin.
 - a. was carry
 - b. was carried
 - c. carried



Let's Practice!

What happened at the beach?

Instructions: Find the words used to describe a nature story in the wordsearch. Use words from the Word Bank below.

Word Bank

feared / safe and sound / slip / spot / miraculously / miracle





Extension Activity

Read an English news article.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and find a short English news article.
- Underline all the past passive verbs you see.
- Write down all the verbs you find.
- Make new sentences using the verbs.
- Read your sentences to a partner.
- Discuss the article that you read.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I read an English news article.

☐
☐

I analyze the article for the past passive tense.

☐
☐

I create new sentences.

☐
☐

I discuss the news article with my partner.

☐
☐


Target Words

- **to fear** (verb): to be afraid of
e.g. A child was feared drowned.
- **safe and sound** (expression): free from danger or injury
e.g. The child was discovered safe and sound.
- **miraculously** (adverb): in a way that goes against laws of the universe
e.g. Miraculously, a dolphin carried the boy to safety.
- **to spot** (verb): to see
Example: The dolphin spotted the boy.
- **to slip** (verb): to enter a place quietly
e.g. Caleb slipped into the water.
- **miracle** (noun): a surprising event considered to be the result of divine intervention
e.g. It's a real miracle!





Learning Points

The Passive Voice

The passive voice is used often in news reports and in business.
You use the passive voice when focusing on the person or thing affected by an action.

Here is an active sentence:

Another swimmer saw the boy and the dolphin.

(Subject + verb + object)

The other swimmer is the focus of the sentence.

Here is a passive sentence:

*The boy and the dolphin **were seen** (by another swimmer).*

(Passive subject + To Be + Past Participle)

The boy and the dolphin are the focus of the sentence.

Examples:

- *Caleb was swept out into the ocean and was unable to swim back.*
- *A child feared drowned was discovered safe and sound.*





Learning Points

The Second Conditional - Talking About Hypothetical Situations

You use the second conditional to talk about unreal or imaginary (hypothetical) situations in the future.

For example:

If I had a million dollars, I would buy a car.

Do you have a million dollars? No.

Is it possible to suddenly get a million dollars? Not really.

What would you do if you had a million dollars? Buy a car.

You use the Simple Past verb + *would*

IF	Conditional	Result
<i>If</i>	Simple Past	would + base verb
<i>If</i>	<i>I married Peter,</i>	<i>I would be happy.</i>
<i>If</i>	<i>it snowed next July,</i>	<i>I would be very surprised</i>
<i>If</i>	<i>I were you,</i>	<i>I would be jumping up and down.</i>

Remember to use a comma (,) after the IF clause.

In conversation, it is common to use contractions. (I would = I'd.)

Examples:

- *If Angel could understand English, I would tell him that I love him.*
- *I would be a dolphin if I could be an animal.*

